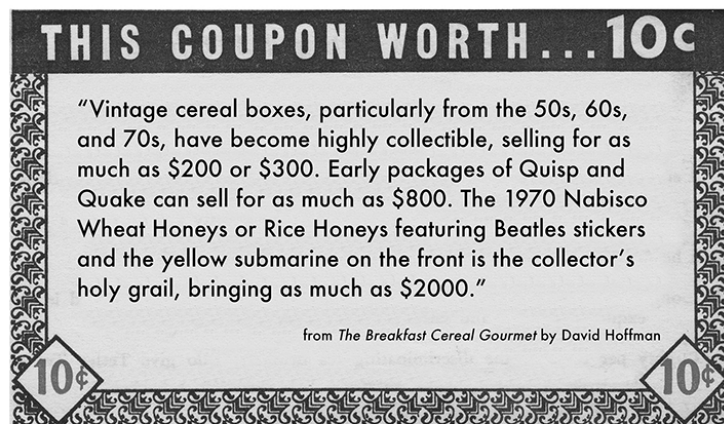


shoes my children wore on these jaunts were obtained free from the Huggies diaper company.

In 1991 I thought I'd died and gone to heaven when a former neighbor called and asked me if I wanted her deceased husband's stash of proofs of purchase and qualifiers that filled an entire basement. Whatever I didn't want, she would be throwing out. I passed over complete cereal boxes from the 70s in favor of the more recent qualifiers. Much later I would regret that move when I got online and saw collectors of cereal boxes paid top dollar for those same boxes, flattened or not.



In the 80s and 90s, magazines devoted to refunding and couponing were prolific, offering support and trading opportunities for people like me, the avid coupon users and refunders. At one point, I was trading with fourteen other women through the mail, each of us filling an envelope for the other from their wish list of coupons and refund forms. We all loved saving money through our hobby. We were, and are, a different breed of shopper, one dubbed "cherry-pickers" by marketers and "crazy" by some of our own friends and family.